

Ryotaro Hiraki

University of Arkansas College of Education and Health Professions
1221 W Mt. Comfort Rd 309, Fayetteville, AR 72703
rhiraki@uark.edu
ryotarohiraki.github.io

Education

University of Arkansas 2025–2026

M.S. in Economic Analytics

Capstone Project: "Returns to Education with College Proximity Instrument: A Deep Learning Approach with Satellite Imagery"

University of Arkansas 2021–2025

B.A. in International and Global Studies, Latin Honors

Honors Thesis: "The Effect of Language on Academic Performance across Countries"

(with Gema Zamarro)

University of Sussex 2024

Exchange Program in Development Studies, Economics, and Education

Research Interests

Economics of Education, Education Policy, Machine Learning, Semiparametric inference

Awards and Honors

Doctoral Academy Fellowship (\$12,000/year), for 4 years.

F.I.E.S. Scholarship (\$4,000), 2024–2025 academic year

In-Progress Research

"Returns to Education in the United States: The Comparison of OLS and Double Machine Learning Approach"

(with Harry Patrinos)

"Returns to Education with College Proximity Instrument: A Deep Learning Approach with Satellite Imagery"

Conference Presentations

"Returns to Education in the United States: The Comparison of OLS and Double Machine Learning Approach"

(with Harry Patrinos)

AEFP annual meeting, 2026

Missouri Valley Economic Association Annual Meeting, 2025

LSUS regional student scholars forum, 2026

Experience

Graduate Assistant

2025–Present

University of Arkansas Fulbright College of Arts and Sciences
Student Success, Retention and Recruitment

Academic Tutor

2022–2025

University of Arkansas Student Success
Subjects: Calculus, French, Japanese

Academic Service

- Ad Hoc Reviewer *Journal of School Choice: International Research and Reform*

2026

Technical Skills

R, python, LaTeX, Git, SQL, PowerBI, Tableau
Languages: Japanese, French